15

OF METROS AND HIGH SPEED RAIL

The New Millennium and Future Rail Cities

END OF THE BRITISH RAIL ERA IN 2013

In 2012, as part of the process to phase out several old pieces of legislation considered as ‘being spent, obsolete, unnecessary or otherwise not now of practical utility’, the British Parliament put up for scrapping thirty-eight old British-era Acts that no longer remained in force. Among them was the Great Indian Peninsula Railway Act of 1949 that laid the foundations of India’s earliest railway company. It was the passing of this Act in the British Parliament in 1849 that had led to the establishment of the rail company that ran India’s first train. [14 6]

The thirty-eight Acts were related to the construction and maintenance of a railway network in India during British rule from across the seven seas. These laws in strict British interest commanded the workings of the early railway companies. The process of their scrapping was complete by 2013, putting a complete end to that era of Indian Railways.

Most of the Acts enabled companies in the Victorian era to be established and to operate various commercial undertakings in, or in connection with, British India. British India included all territories and places which were governed by the Queen through the Governor General of India.

The repeal proposals were brought in by the Law Commission to review statute law relating to the Indian subcontinent, which remained on the UK statute book after India, Pakistan (and later Bangladesh), Ceylon